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Digital Passion

Fuelling The Pursuit Of Technology Knowledge

Lead Feature

Clickety-Clack: Googlewhack!

Starting off from an Indian security analyst's claim, we try and look at exactly how secure Google's AdSense programme is

Team Digit

“Google is God,” many are apt to declare. And they are, really, close to being right... in certain senses. For example, you get a .odt file from someone when you expected a Word document. You scratch your head for a while—“open document something?”—and then you give up and do the usual thing: www.google.com. Type in just “.odt” without the quotes, and you’re in business: a link to a forum, a link to a page, and seconds later, via a link you find, you have a Word document. Try it!

Now go to, for example, Yahoo! Search. *Otago Daily Times*. Not so helpful...? Next up: some world maps. Not so helpful...?

That example graphically demonstrates why Google is the most popular search engine. No-one can say it is “the best,” because that’s a much tougher question.

Now, back to the clicks: all this fabulous search technology, all the power that Google has come to be known for, all its great products, rest on one edifice—its advertising programmes, AdWords and AdSense. (We’re focusing here on AdSense.) It seems money is just a click away—to be precise, a few thousand clicks. Those clicks can be engineered.

The Working

For those of you hearing the word for the first time, AdSense is Google’s word for the programme whereby they place ads on a site or blog based on its content. Anyone can have an AdSense account, though to actually make money off it, you’ll probably need a blog or site with good, extensive content.

The concept is simple: after you sign up for an AdSense account, bots “look” at your page and place relevant ads on it. Those are the “Ads by

Ads by Google

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